EMBER MOTH

A tiny night moth with a lantern on its tail collects drifting embers and jumps over hungry shadows to keep the forest lit.

Author / roles: solo project (Ars, ars512) - one person is designer, programmer, UI artist and tester until teams form in week 14.

1. Title + pitch

Ember Moth - "light the night, dodge the gloom". Collect embers for score, avoid shadows that cost hearts.

2. Genre / platform

Casual arcade runner-jumper. Android and iOS, **landscape** only. Touch controls; keyboard (A/D, Space, Esc) works in the editor.

3. 2D or 3D

2D. All art is generated by code (flat shapes with soft glows), so the whole game shares one visual style: a dusk sky, dark hills, amber light.

4. Core loop

Run - Jump - Collect - Dodge - and back to Run. Embers give +10; every ~300 points the shadows come faster and denser. Three hearts; at zero the game ends with a score screen (restart / menu).

5. Controls

Control	Position	Action
Virtual stick	bottom-left, 320x320	run left / right
JUMP button	bottom-right, 250x250	jump; press again in the air for a double jump
Pause (II)	top-right, 130x130	stops time, opens the pause panel
Pause panel	center	Resume - continue; Restart - reload level; Menu - back to main menu
Main menu	center-right	Play - load the level; Quit - exit the app

6. Content

- 1 endless level, with difficulty rising by score (MVP); 2 more backdrops (forest, caves) as stretch.
- Enemies: 1 type (gloom shadow) in the MVP, 1 extra flying shadow later.
- Items: embers (score); a heart pickup later.

7. Art and sound

Style: flat, soft-glow 2D with a warm-on-cold palette (amber #FFB547 on night blue #0B1030). Sprites and UI sprites are drawn by an editor script, so there are no asset packs and nothing clashes. The default Unity UI font is used for all text with a dark outline for readability. Sound (week 11-12): soft chimes from a free CC0 pack for embers, a low thud for damage, one calm ambient loop - kept quiet and consistent with the night mood.

8. MVP (week-15 build)

- Main menu, HUD, pause and game-over screens that fit 16:9, notch phones and 4:3 tablets.
- Moth movement with double jump, embers, shadows, hearts, score, rising difficulty.
- Saved best score, enemy behavior polish, sound effects and music, simple particle effects.
- Android build that runs at 60 fps on a mid-range phone.

9. Cut list (NOT making)

- Multiplayer, online leaderboards, in-app purchases and ads.
- Multiple playable characters and a skin shop.
- 3D art, story cutscenes, a level editor.
- Portrait mode.

10. Plan, weeks 9-13

Week	Ready at the end of the week
9	GDD, GitHub repo, Menu / HUD / Pause UI, working core loop (this assignment)
10	Enemy AI: a second shadow type that chases / flies in waves
11	Saving: best score and settings stored with PlayerPrefs / JSON
12	Sound and music, mute toggle in the menu
13	Visual effects (particles, screen shake), balance pass, Android build test